it was known in the West). This aimed to provide direct communications between Washington and Moscow that had been conspicuously absent in the crisis. The telephone conversations between President Muffley and Premier Kissof spring immediately to mind. In fact, the 'hot line' involved a teleprinter link between the Kremlin and the Pentagon (first used during the 1967 Arab-Israeli war). Second, there was agreement in September 1963 between Washington and Moscow to support a resolution in the UN General Assembly to ban weapons of mass destruction in outer space.

Third, and most significant, was the Partial Test Ban Treaty (PTBT). In August 1963 the United States, the Soviet Union, and the United Kingdom signed the Partial Test Ban Treaty, which prohibited nuclear testing in the atmosphere, outer space, and under water. It was the first nuclear arms control agreement of the Cold War (though Don Munton argues that the Cuba-Turkey/Italy deal was, in effect, the first).[35] The PTBT was seen as a valuable step in easing Cold War tension and laying the foundation for future negotiations between Moscow and Washington. It was also of considerable importance in removing the danger of radioactive fallout from the atmosphere. It nevertheless fell short of initial hopes of a comprehensive agreement that would ban all nuclear tests. Nor did it attempt to freeze or reduce the nuclear arsenals of existing nuclear weapons states or dampen the expectations of aspiring members of the nuclear club.

When they met on 21 October, John F. Kennedy told David Ormsby-Gore that 'the existence of nuclear weapons [makes] a secure and rational world impossible. We must somehow find a means to get rid of nuclear weapons.'[36] The statement made an impact on the British ambassador. In June 1963 Kennedy delivered what became known as his 'peace speech' at the American University in Washington. According to Michael Beschloss, 'This lyrical address was easily the best speech of Kennedy's life.'[37] Nikita Khrushchev pretty much agreed, not just because JFK called for a reappraisal of relations with Moscow and helped with the end-game negotiations on the PTBT, but because it was of use in his dealings with Beijing.

Notwithstanding the eloquence of the American University speech, Kennedy's arms policies remained pragmatic. He was drawn to the idea of